THE MILLENNIAL DEAL

We the People of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic Tranquility, provide for the common defence, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty to ourselves and our Posterity, do ordain and establish this Constitution for the United States of America.

— The Preamble of the United States Constitution, written by the Founders as a giant middle finger to an unfathomably wealthy human who wanted to rule them with zero accountability.

Of more worth is one honest man to society and in the sight of God, than all the crowned ruffians that ever lived.

— Thomas Paine

Practices of the unscrupulous money changers stand indicted in the court of public opinion, rejected by the hearts and minds of men.

— Franklin Delano Roosevelt

This is a practical, systemic proposal to end American oligarchy and take on the deeper problem beneath it: people pursue power, power concentrates, and eventually everyone suffers.

This is not a socialist pamphlet. It outlines and advocates for a reformed, efficient, inclusive capitalism— one that brings together both market and democratic forces to end wage slavery for good.

We'll still have rich people and broke people. We'll still have cultural divides and petty squabbles and personal biases. But they'll be happening inside a framework where they're a lot easier to manage and resolve. People won't be driven mad by scarcity on one end and incomprehensible abundance on the other.

Throughout history, labor has had one advantage over capital: its sheer numbers. Capital knows this and uses cultural issues to split labor up into manageable groups. This document gives us a north star. Regardless of whether you're a Bernie bro or a Trumper or anywhere in between— if you make your living by selling your time to someone else in exchange for a set wage, this is for you.

— Written by an anonymous American Millennial from the Midwest. I have no institutional backing, no donor relationships, and no political career to protect.

The full platform documents are available separately.

Text organized and compiled with assistance from Claude AI.

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Closing: A Thousand Years

What Is This?

The American Founders studied every republic in history, designed a system of checks and balances to prevent tyranny, and wrote the most influential political document of the modern era. Two and a half centuries later, three people have more wealth than the bottom half of the country combined.

The Millennial Deal is an attempt to permanently and categorically alleviate this.

Think of it as a Project 2025 for labor vs. capital, or a Powell memorandum for the working class.

The project's name carries two meanings:

First: The Millennial generation — the first generation in American history to be poorer than their parents — will be the ones who implement it (at first).

Second: It is designed for the millennium. The way Roman law was a thousand-year program, and the way the Founders intended the Constitution to be a thousand-year document. The goal is for people in 3026 to be referencing the ideas put forth here, the same way we're referencing the Romans. Yes, that's ambitious. It's also necessary.

Abolition, the New Deal, the Civil Rights movement — every consequential reform in American history took decades to bear fruit. The pattern is consistent. The question is whether we now know enough — about incentive structures, institutional design, and the specific mechanisms of capture — to build something that holds longer than what came before.

250 years ago we adopted political democracy. Now it's time for economic democracy.

PART I

How Much?

$28 to $31 trillion

Total US economic output per year — the total value of everything America produces in one year.*

$162 trillion

Total wealth held by American households (as of the end of 2024)— everything: houses, stocks, retirement accounts, businesses.

$50 trillion

Held by the top 1% — about a third of all household wealth, held by roughly 2.6 million people.

$4.1 trillion

Held by the bottom 50% — 165 million Americans — about 2.5% of all household wealth.

$7.8 trillion

Held by America's 902 to 980 billionaires. In 1989 there were 66 American billionaires.

This number fluctuates, but as of this writing (spring 2026), it's been checked through numerous sources and is correct.

Pleonexia— Greek— the insatiable desire to have more than one's fair share; the compulsive acquisition of wealth, power, and advantage beyond any rational need or natural limit.

Learn this word. It should be as ubiquitous as the word "democracy".

A million seconds is 11.5 days.

A billion seconds is 31.7 years. If you spent $1,000 every single day since the birth of Christ, you would not yet have spent a billion dollars. You would have spent about $735 million.

A trillion seconds is 31,709 years—before the end of the last ice age, before agriculture, before written language.

The United States federal government spends approximately $7 trillion per year.*

Of that: $1.5 trillion is Social Security. $1.8 trillion is Medicare and Medicaid. Roughly $890 billion is military. Interest on the debt is just over a trillion (for now). Another $850 billion goes to mandatory safety-net programs and veterans' benefits.

The remaining $1 trillion covers everything else— education, infrastructure, science, law enforcement, and the daily operations of the entire civilian government.

****again, this number fluctuates depending on the year. As of spring 2026, this is the accurate number.***

PART II

What Happened?

1919 — Dodge v. Ford Motor Company

The Michigan Supreme Court rules that corporations exist solely to maximize shareholder returns. It's never made into a federal law, and it never even gets to the federal Supreme Court, but it becomes the philosophical operating system of American capitalism.

1947 — Taft-Hartley Act

Union-busting legislation strips workers of key organizing rights. Union membership begins its long decline. Wages follow. This takes decades to reach its full wretched potential.

1968 — Federal minimum wage peaks

At its peak purchasing power, the minimum wage was $1.60 an hour, which is worth about $14 in today's dollars. In 2026, the minimum wage is currently $7.25, the equivalent of 80 cents an hour in 1968. Congress hasn't raised it since 2009, though a bill was introduced in June 2026 to raise it to $25 an hour, the same number this platform advocates for.

1970 — Milton Friedman's doctrine

"The Social Responsibility of Business Is to Increase Its Profits." An op-ed in New York Times Magazine becomes the standard ideology of American corporate culture.

1971 — The Powell Memo

Largely in response to the activism and legislative achievements of the 1960s (and a general sense that the rabble were getting too uppity in their demands for a Great Society), corporate lawyer Lewis Powell writes a confidential memo to the Chamber of Commerce blueprinting the corporate capture of American politics: fund think tanks, capture universities, buy judges, buy Congress.

1976 — Buckley v. Valeo

The Supreme Court rules that spending money on political campaigns is protected speech. The door to unlimited political spending opens.

1978 — Bankruptcy reform

Student loans are made non-dischargeable in bankruptcy. Lenders stop caring whether borrowers can repay. Universities raise tuition accordingly.

1982 — SEC Rule 10b-18

Stock buybacks—previously considered market manipulation—are legalized. American corporations begin spending trillions to inflate their own stock prices instead of paying workers or building things.

1994 — The Violent Crime Control and Law Enforcement Act of 1994

At 356 pages, it was the largest crime bill in history and remains so as of 2026. Mandatory minimums expanded. Private prisons incentivized. Mass incarceration accelerates. The US goes from having a prison population comparable to other developed nations to having 25% of the world's prisoners.

1996 — Section 230

A provision of the Communications Decency Act of 1996, it says platforms are shielded from liability for content. It's designed for bulletin boards. Three decades later, it's being applied to AI systems that generate the content themselves.

2010 — Citizens United v. FEC

Supreme Court rules that corporations have First Amendment rights. In 2014, McCutcheon v. Federal Election Commission takes away any remaining limits. Unlimited political spending is protected speech. Bribery is legalized and democracy now effectively functions such that your influence is ultimately determined by your bank account, not your vote.

Each of these decisions was made by specific people, for specific reasons, serving specific financial interests, with all of them pushing headlong toward one goal: the accumulation of wealth and power.

A life in which a person is free from the frictions of everyday human existence.

A life in which one right trumps all others: the right to be served.

A life in which you don't worry about money, you worry about time.

That's what they're after, that's what they've achieved, and it's why they would rather allow the atrophy of organized society than live in a world where they can't have it.

These are human impulses, to strive for an easier life.

But not when it comes at the expense of civilization itself.

None of these decisions need be permanent.

PART III

The Deal

Put simply, here's what we could do. Some of it you've heard before, some of it you haven't. A lot of it is already normal in other countries.

Systems evolve or they collapse. Period. This platform is about encouraging—or allowing—ours to evolve.

The only serious objection to most of what follows is, "It would make a small number of extraordinarily wealthy people somewhat less extraordinarily wealthy."

That's been the main anchor on most societal progress throughout human history.

Enough is enough.

****Note on how to read this platform:** The Millennial Deal is a set of separate proposals, not a package to be accepted or rejected as a whole. Each plank stands on its own: its own problem, its own mechanism, its own funding. Some will have wide agreement from the start, and those should pass first. Others are harder arguments, and they can wait for now. If you agree with half of this, let's pass the half you agree with, and we'll talk about the rest. **Don't let good be the enemy of perfect.****

SECTION 1

Labor

Wages, Healthcare, and the Conditions of a Decent Life

The Current Poverty Line Is a Lie

The official federal poverty line is $33,000 for a family of four. That number is based on a formula from 1963 that calculated food costs and multiplied by three. It has not been meaningfully updated since. The Census Bureau's own Supplemental Poverty Measure — which accounts for housing, healthcare, childcare, and transportation in addition to food, and adjusts for regional cost differences — already puts the honest floor significantly higher, ranging from $35,000 in low-cost areas to $60,000 in expensive cities. MIT's Living Wage Calculator, which models what it actually costs to meet basic needs by location, puts the number higher still — between $85,000 and $140,000 depending on where you live. The official line is a contested number. The argument it obscures is not: tens of millions of Americans classified as "not in poverty" cannot afford a medical emergency, a car repair, or a month without a paycheck despite often working more than full time. The floor we set for wages and benefits has to be calibrated to what life actually costs — not to a sixty year old formula that bears no resemblance to the economy people are actually living in. For reference, using the math from 1963 today is the equivalent of 1963 using math from 1906.

The GEO: Gross Economic Outlook

GDP — Gross Domestic Product — was designed in the 1940s to measure wartime industrial output. It has been the primary lens through which every president, every news anchor, and every investor judges national economic health, despite the fact that it goes up when someone gets cancer or when a hurricane destroys a city, counts incarceration as prosperity, and cannot distinguish between a billionaire's $10 billion gain and a million workers each getting $10,000 raises. It measures activity. It does not measure whether anyone is doing well. This platform replaces GDP as the standard national economic metric with the Gross Economic Outlook — the GEO — a composite index that incorporates GDP alongside median wage growth, life expectancy, housing affordability, food security, healthcare access, environmental health, and the estimated value of unpaid caregiving labor, calculated by a dedicated office within the Bureau of Economic Analysis, insulated by a fixed term and for-cause removal only, using a formula set by Congress and updated only by statute. When the president says the economy is doing well, the GEO is the number they are required to cite. The number we use to measure how the country is doing should measure how the entire country is doing, not just the stock market.

The $25 Minimum Wage

This is the definition of overdue. The federal minimum wage peaked in purchasing power in 1968 at roughly $14 in today's dollars. Workers produce significantly more per hour than they did then. None of that productivity gain has gone to wages. $25 per hour is where the minimum wage would be today if it had kept pace with productivity. Once raised to this threshold, it will be indexed to inflation so no future Congress can let it erode again. **In June 2026, Senator Chris Murphy and Representatives Delia Ramirez (D-Ill.), Jesús "Chuy" García (D-Ill.), Lateefah Simon (D-Calif.), and Analilia*

Mejia (D-N.J.) introduced the Living Wage For All Act, which calls for a 25 dollar minimum wage. Whatever political challenges it faces, this is good progress.

Medicare for All

The only ones who stand to benefit from America's current system are the bureaucrats and healthcare executives (not to mention the politicians they donate to) who don't provide any actual healthcare. According to a 2022 Commonwealth Fund analysis, the US spends roughly twice per capita what other developed nations spend on healthcare and has the lowest life expectancy, the highest infant mortality rate, and the highest maternal mortality rate of any wealthy country. The difference is not doctors or hospitals. It is the billing labyrinth that a person and their doctor must navigate in order to get anything paid for. A single-payer system eliminates that overhead and redirects it to actual care. More importantly: when your healthcare is not tied to your job, you can quit. You can bargain. You can tell a shitty employer, "No." That is the most fundamental power shift in this platform.

Lift the Social Security Cap

Social Security taxes stop at $184,500 a year. A nurse pays into the program on every dollar she earns. A CEO making $20 million stops paying in sometime in early January. The cap is lifted, and every dollar of wage income pays the same rate. Benefits stay capped, so this is not a windfall for the wealthy. The Social Security Administration's own analysts estimate that eliminating the cap this way would close two-thirds of the program's long-range shortfall on its own. Surveys show raising the cap is the most popular fix there is. The program that kept millions of elderly Americans out of poverty for ninety years does not need to be cut. It needs everyone to pay in.

Make It Easy to Join a Union

Union membership peaked in 1954 at nearly 35% and now sits at roughly 10%. The decline tracks almost perfectly with the decline in the working-class share of GDP. Card check recognition lets a union form when a majority of workers sign authorization cards — removing the delay between majority support and formal certification that employers currently exploit. Same-day organizing rights close the window for captive-audience campaigns and retaliatory firings. Criminal penalties for union-busting replace the current fine structure, which functions as a cost of doing business, with consequences that match the scale of the interference. The goal is a legal infrastructure that makes organizing easier than defeating it, which is the opposite of what currently exists. This will apply to many industries— fast food, retail, gig work, etc. Americans are often nostalgic for the days of manufacturing, but that misses the point— we didn't just really love putting cars together, we loved that we got paid enough doing it to build decent lives. Unions are largely what made that possible.

The 32-Hour Work Week

The forty-hour week became federal law in 1938 and took full effect in 1940. Output per worker has risen enormously since then. The legal workweek has not moved an hour. This platform lowers the overtime threshold from 40 hours to 32, in steps, with no cut in pay. Work past 32 hours is paid at time and a half. A full-time job stays a full-time job; the week gets shorter and the paycheck doesn't. Small employers get a longer runway, and industries that can't close an extra day, like hospitals, restaurants and factories, cover the hours with more people, not fewer.* This isn't a leap in the dark. In a 2022 UK trial, 61 companies and about 2,900 employees moved to a four-day week at

full pay. Fifty-six of the 61 planned to keep it, revenue was essentially unchanged, and 71% of employees reported less burnout. A 2025 study in Nature Human Behaviour, covering about 3,000 employees at 141 organizations, found less burnout and higher job satisfaction. The firms in those studies chose to try it, which is why this platform phases it in rather than flipping a switch. A paycheck that requires every waking hour isn't a better life. It's a longer shift. People with time raise kids, care for parents, see their friends, and show up for their towns. **In September 2026, Senator Bernie Sanders and Representative Mark Takano reintroduced the Thirty-Two Hour Work-week Act, which would set the standard workweek at 32 hours without a loss in pay or benefits.*

National Service and Student Debt Exchange

Every American who completes one year of voluntary national service—through AmeriCorps, the Peace Corps, the rail and grid construction initiative detailed later in this platform as well as neighborhood renovation programs, community gardens, or other qualifying programs—receives one year of public college tuition, fully paid. For Americans already carrying student debt: one year of qualifying service retires one year of accrued debt. You are not "forgiven" anything. You work it off in service to the country, on a schedule that you determine. The people who already paid their loans (including the author of this document) are not excluded—the programs implemented by the national service benefit them going forward.

Colleges Share the Risk

In 1978, lenders stopped needing to care whether borrowers could repay. Colleges never had to care at all. Now they will. Public colleges that accept federal aid hold tuition increases to inflation. Any college whose graduates default at high rates pays back a share of the defaulted loans, so the institution that set the price has a stake in whether it was worth it. Community college tuition is free in every state that matches federal funding. You can't fix student debt forever by paying it off. You fix it by changing the price.

Pay Teachers Like the Professionals They Are

Teaching is among the most consequential jobs in the country and among the worst compensated relative to that consequence. The average American teacher earns roughly $74,000 per year — a number that sounds reasonable until you adjust it for inflation and find that teachers have lost 5% of their purchasing power over the last decade while the job has gotten harder. Starting salaries average $46,000. The average lawyer earns $151,000. The average software engineer earns $120,000. This is not a natural market outcome — it is the result of decades of systematic underinvestment in a profession that is almost entirely publicly funded and therefore entirely subject to political will. This platform sets a federal baseline: no teacher in a public school that accepts federal funding earns less than $75,000, with a target average of $100,000 phased in over five years, funded through the same federal education infrastructure that currently subsidizes standardized testing regimes and administrative bloat. Compensation above the baseline is tied to results defined by educators in collaboration with their communities.

Teacher-Governed Schools

The same logic that puts workers on corporate boards (in the Capital section of this document) applies to schools. Teachers are the people with direct, daily empirical

knowledge of what works in a given classroom with a given population of kids. Administrators are several layers removed from that knowledge — yet under the current structure they set curriculum, assessment criteria, and pedagogy while teachers execute it. That is backwards for the same reason shareholder primacy is backwards: the people furthest from the work are making the decisions for the people doing it. The model this platform moves toward: teachers collectively govern the school's educational direction through a democratic structure, and professional administrators handle facilities, budgets, HR, and legal compliance — answering to the teachers, not the other way around. The principal serves the faculty. The superintendent serves the schools. The people in the room with the children collectively determine what is taught and how it is taught.

Applying for Jobs: "IT'S ON MY RESUME"

Hiring has been automated in ways that serve HR departments, not candidates or employers. Algorithmic resume screening filters out qualified people who don't use the exact keywords a committee wrote into a job description, while putting through people who have learned to game the system. The result is hiring that gets worse while appearing more efficient. Two rules fix the structural problem. First: if you uploaded a resume, you do not retype it. Any information present in an uploaded document cannot be required to be manually re-entered as a condition of application. Second: algorithmic screening tools are subject to the same anti-discrimination standards as human hiring managers. You get rejected on your merits, not on whether your resume contained the right buzzwords (and certainly not on anything related to your identity). Employers are liable for screening outcomes the same way they are liable for discriminatory human decisions. Every rejected candidate has a right to know why. Every applicant retains the right to a human review of any algorithmic rejection upon request, at no cost, within a defined response window.

Paid Family Leave & Universal Childcare

This platform passes the FAMILY Act, championed by Senator Kirsten Gillibrand since 2013 — twelve weeks of paid family leave funded by a 0.2% payroll contribution split evenly between worker and employer. It uses the same model as Social Security and covers every worker including gig and self-employed. On childcare: we already publicly fund education from age five through eighteen. The argument for stopping at five has never been principled — it's just where the political will ran out. This platform extends the line back to birth. Federal funding flows directly to licensed nonprofit and public childcare providers — for-profit centers are ineligible — in exchange for capped parent fees and a hard wage floor for childcare workers as a condition of funding, not a suggestion. Workforce training and educator recruitment programs are funded and built out before fee reductions take effect, so supply meets demand rather than chasing it. Universal Pre-K for ages three and four is included. No vouchers. Every dollar spent returns between one-fifty and three dollars in workforce participation, tax revenue, and reduced social program dependency. You want people to continue having kids and going to work? This is what you need.

SECTION 2

Capital

Ownership, Wealth, and Who the Economy Actually Works For

Codetermination

Every corporation above 1,000 employees is required to elect 50% of its board of directors from and by its workforce. Not appointed by management. Elected by workers, accountable to workers, with the same fiduciary standing as shareholder-elected directors. The CEO of a codetermined company answers to a board that includes the people who run its warehouses, write its code, and build its products. Germany has operated this way since the 1970s. Their workers earn more, their companies invest longer-term, and they don't offshore jobs to juice quarterly earnings because the people whose jobs would be offshored have a vote.

Worker Co-operatives

Any firm whose market capitalization exceeds $10 billion at any point in a rolling five-year window faces a choice. Option one: worker directors move from half the board to a majority, and the 20-to-1 pay ratio becomes 10-to-1. Option two: sell the company to the workers. Owners who choose the sale receive full capital gains deferral, the same treatment the tax code already gives through sales to Employee Stock Ownership Plans, expanded and uncapped, with the purchase financed through the Worker Equity Fund rather than loaded onto the company as debt. Don't want to share the boardroom with the people who work the floor? Sell it to them, and the government will give you a tax break, and we both know you love tax breaks.

The 25% Rule

Any corporation controlling more than 25% of its specific market triggers an automatic antitrust review — not a polite letter, a mandatory investigation with a deadline. Any corporation that dominates its market outright, or that owns the infrastructure its competitors depend on while competing against them, is designated a Tier 1 Monopoly and subject to mandatory divestiture. Amazon cannot own the marketplace, the shipping network, and the products simultaneously. Google cannot own search, the ad exchange, and the browser. This is restoration of the competitive conditions that markets require to function. Tier 1 Monopoly designations are filed simultaneously, but divestitures are sequenced — the DOJ gets significant new resources and cases are prioritized by market harm. The legal designation triggers a mandatory compliance clock. The restructuring follows on a supervised timeline, case by case. The AT&T breakup took years of litigation and planning before the actual split. This is that process, applied to a larger set of targets with more preparation behind it. Being successful is not a crime. Being the toll booth everyone else has to pay to reach the market is.

The 90/999 Wealth Cap

Beyond a billion dollars, an additional dollar does not improve anyone's quality of life. What it does is purchase political influence, distort markets, fund the think tanks that write the laws, and establish dynastic wealth that competes with democratic governance itself. The 90% marginal tax on all assets and income above $999 million is not confiscation. It is a structural recognition that the fortunes in question were built using American infrastructure, American workers, American legal protections, and American consumers — and that wealth concentrated beyond a certain point is a direct threat to every institution that keeps society stable. Refer back to Part I: at $1,000 a day, a person with $999 million takes 2,737 years to spend it. Nobody is going hungry at the cap. Nobody is having their ambitions squelched. Most of these fortunes are held in stock, so the cap can be paid in shares rather than cash. Shares above the cap are transferred into a public trust, with a portion seeding the Worker Equity Fund. There is no fire sale, no forced dumping of trillions of dollars of stock onto the market, and the public and the workforce end up owning a stake in the companies they helped build. The objection that this will drive capital out of the country is answered in the Capital Flight Kill-Switch section. The complexity of the structure determines the timeline. The direction is not negotiable.

The Capital Flight Kill-Switch

The first objection to the wealth cap is always the same: what stops billionaires from just leaving? The answer is an 80% exit tax. Wealth built in America, using American infrastructure, American workers, American legal protections, and American consumers, does not simply relocate to Switzerland or some private island. If you choose to renounce citizenship, 80% of your wealth above $999 million stays here — as a recognition that it wasn't built in isolation. The exit tax works in two phases. Before the wealth cap is enforced, it applies to fortunes that try to leave ahead of it, and a 24-month look-back reaches any wealth moved offshore or out of citizenship from the day the cap legislation is introduced — the debate over the bill is not a window to escape it. Once the cap is in force, the exit tax applies to any growth above the cap that has accumulated since it was last assessed. The 'highway robbery' framing assumes the billionaire built it alone — and that unlimited accumulation is the natural endpoint of a free market. It isn't. It's what destroys free markets. A fortune large enough to purchase the regulatory environment, the legal system, and the political infrastructure that governs competition isn't participating in a market. It is replacing one. Additional capital controls via executive order close the most common avoidance mechanisms: foreign entity restructuring, offshore trusts, shell company ownership transfers. Income derived from American sources remains taxable regardless of where you relocate — you can leave the country, but you cannot leave the economy that made you. And renouncing your citizenship to avoid a tax on wealth above $999 million is a public act with public consequences. The people who built that fortune with you will notice. You can leave. 80 percent stays.

Millennial Accounts: Every Child Starts With a Stake in the US

Congress has already built the pipe. Since 2025, children born through 2028 receive a $1,000 federal deposit into an investment account they can't touch until 18, when it can go toward school, a first home, or a business.* It's a good idea at a small scale. This platform makes it universal and meaningful. Every child born in America gets an account, not just the ones born in a four-year window, and the seed comes from the public trust built from the wealth cap instead of a flat $1,000. The trust adds to each account on a schedule set in law, so a child who starts with nothing reaches adulthood with a real stake in the country's growth. The rules stay as they are: broad index funds

only, low fees, locked until 18. No new agency is needed. It's the wealth cap doing what it was always for: wealth built by everyone, shared with everyone's kids. **Under the 2025 law, children born from January 1, 2025 through January 1, 2029 receive a $1,000 Treasury deposit, and family or others can add up to $5,000 per year.*

The Step-Up in Basis: Closing the Dynastic Wealth Loophole

When a wealthy person dies, the unrealized gains on their assets — the increase in value that was never taxed because the asset was never sold — are permanently wiped out under current law. Their heirs inherit at current market value, and the entire lifetime of appreciation escapes taxation forever. This is called the step-up in basis, and it is the single most consequential mechanism of dynastic wealth entrenchment in the American tax code. It is not a death tax. No money changes hands at death. It is the elimination of a tax that was never collected on gains that absolutely existed. The step-up in basis is eliminated. Unrealized gains are treated as realized at death. This applies only to estates exceeding $50 million in total value — the threshold where stepped-up basis stops protecting a family home or a retirement nest egg and starts protecting dynastic capital. Below that line, current law remains untouched. Furthermore, family farm and small business exemptions are preserved — again, this targets dynastic capital accumulation, not a family that built something and wants to pass it on.

Kill "Buy Borrow Die"

The wealthiest Americans have spent decades paying effectively zero income tax on billions in economic gains through a three-step mechanism. Buy appreciating assets. Borrow against them at low interest rates, as loan proceeds aren't taxable income. Die, at which point the step-up in basis wipes the unrealized gains permanently and the heirs pay off the loans with untaxed inherited wealth. The whole cycle produces a person who accumulates and spends billions across an entire lifetime without ever triggering a tax event. This platform closes the Die leg with the step-up in basis elimination. It closes the Borrow leg here. Any loan above $5 million collateralized by appreciated assets is a deemed realization event — the gains are recognized and taxed at the moment of borrowing, not deferred until a sale or death that may never come. You can still take the loan. You just can't use it to permanently avoid recognizing the gains that made it possible. Loans taken to invest back into a business, fund operations, or refinance income-producing real estate are exempt — the target is lifestyle borrowing against untaxed gains, not the financing that actually builds things.

The Corporate Kill-Switch

A corporate charter is not a natural right. It is a privilege the state grants — limited liability, the ability to raise capital, legal personhood separate from the humans who own it — and for most of American history, that grant came with the understood possibility of revocation for serious misconduct. That power still exists on paper in most state corporate codes. It has gone almost entirely unused for a century. This platform revives it with defined, specific triggers instead of leaving it as a dead letter: repeated and intentional interference with union organizing after a final legal finding, wage theft above a statutory threshold repeated after a first violation, and criminal environmental negligence resulting in serious harm. A single violation triggers escalating penalties. A pattern — the same violation repeated after the corporation has already been found liable for it — triggers mandatory charter revocation proceedings. This is

not a business making a mistake. It is a business that has been told to stop, was given the chance to stop, and chose not to. The corporation's assets are liquidated or transferred to a court-supervised successor entity, with employee wages, pensions, and creditor claims protected ahead of shareholders. You do not get to treat legal accountability as a cost of doing business when the legal accountability is losing the right to do business at all.

Mandatory 20-to-1 CEO Pay Ratio

In 1965, the average American CEO earned roughly 20 times what a typical worker at the same company made. By 2024, that ratio had grown past 280-to-1 — not because executives became fourteen times more essential to their companies' success, but because the mechanisms that once tied executive pay to worker pay broke down one at a time, deliberately, over five decades. This platform restores the historical ratio as a legal ceiling. No corporation above the codetermination threshold may compensate its chief executive or any other top executive — including salary, bonuses, and the realized value of stock awards and options — at more than 20 times the total compensation of its median worker. Contractors and outsourced staff who work for the company full time count as workers in that calculation, so a company can't shrink its workforce on paper to make the math look better. Compensation above that ratio faces a 100% federal tax on the excess. This is not a cap on ambition. It is a restoration of the relationship between pay and contribution that prevailed for the most broadly prosperous decades in American economic history, undone deliberately and now undone again.

SECTION 3

Finance

Markets, Taxes, and the Rules of Money

Ban Stock Buybacks

Stock buybacks were effectively illegal until 1982, when the SEC under Reagan issued a rule creating a safe harbor. In the decade after the 2017 tax cuts, S&P 500 companies spent more on buybacks than on wages and capital investment combined. The rule is revoked. When a corporation generates surplus cash it has three legal destinations: reinvest in the business, pay workers, or distribute dividends that face normal tax treatment. No more inflating the stock price to enrich executives whose compensation is tied to share value.

The Speed Bump Tax

A financial transaction tax of 0.1% on every stock, bond, and derivatives trade. For a retail investor buying $10,000 of stock and holding it for years, this costs $10—imperceptible. For a high-frequency trading firm executing a million trades a day to profit from microsecond price discrepancies, it is existential. High-frequency trading produces nothing, and this tax is designed to shrink it. The revenue does not depend on high-frequency trading surviving: the Joint Committee on Taxation estimated that a tax at this rate would raise $777 billion over ten years—roughly $75 billion a year—and that estimate already assumes trading volume falls once the tax takes effect. Every dollar is dedicated to the rail and grid programs explained later in this document.

Long-Term Capital Gains Reform

The tax code currently rewards holding a stock for thirteen months more than holding it for thirteen years. One year is not long-term — it is the minimum required to avoid being taxed as a day trader. This platform creates a tiered structure: ordinary income treatment under one year, modest reduction at one to three years, the current preferential rate at three to ten years, and a further reduced rate at ten or more years. A decade of patient capital deserves a decade's reward.

Close the Loopholes & Fund the IRS.

It's an accepted and even convenient reality that the tax code is full of loopholes. Each loophole has a name (carried interest, offshore deferral, pass-through abuse, the step-up in basis), a legislative history, and a set of donors who paid for it. Closing them is both practical and imperative. Simultaneously, the IRS becomes funded at the level the job actually requires. The agency has been systematically defunded for decades, specifically in the audit divisions that handle complex returns for high-income filers and corporations. That is not an accident — the people who lobbied to defund it were

the people it would have audited. The Congressional Budget Office estimates that every dollar invested in IRS enforcement returns between five and twelve dollars in recovered revenue. That is the highest-return investment the federal government can make. the enforcement capacity is rebuilt, the rules are set, and the IRS is empowered to do its annoying but extremely necessary job.

The Tax Reduction Trigger

The goal of this platform is not permanent, punitive high taxation. It is ensuring that everyone — especially the wealthiest individuals and corporations — pays what they already legally owe before anyone talks about reducing what they owe. Automatic tax reductions kick in for defined income levels once the tax loopholes are closed, the IRS is functional, each major program reaches a defined sustainable funding threshold maintained for three consecutive years, and the federal deficit has meaningfully declined over that same period. This is a structural commitment written into the legislation. The reforms have to actually deliver before the cuts happen. A declining deficit also means that when a genuine crisis arrives — a pandemic, a war, a natural disaster — the country has the fiscal capacity to respond without catastrophic borrowing. Tax cuts can and should come again. But first, make sure the system is funded and stable.

Glass-Steagall: Make Banking Boring Again

The Glass-Steagall Act separated commercial banking from investment banking for sixty-six years. The logic was simple: banks that hold ordinary people's deposits and make ordinary business loans should not be in the business of speculative trading, because when the speculation fails, the deposits go with it and the taxpayer covers the difference. Congress repealed the separation in 1999 under the Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act, with enthusiastic support from both parties and the full backing of an industry that spent $300 million lobbying for it. Nine years later, the largest financial crisis since the Depression arrived precisely through the channels the repeal had opened — commercial banks holding toxic mortgage securities and investment arms of deposit-taking institutions placing bets that vaporized when the housing market turned. The bailout cost the public hundreds of billions. The executives kept their bonuses. Glass-Steagall is reinstated. Commercial banks take deposits and make loans. Investment banks speculate with their own capital and the capital of clients who understand they are speculating. When the investment bank blows up, it blows up. The depositor's savings are not in the building. Banking becomes boring again. Boring is better, boring is safer.

Audit the Pentagon

The Department of Defense controls the largest budget of any federal agency and is the only major agency that has never passed a financial audit. It has failed every annual audit since full audits began in 2018 — eight in a row as of this writing — and still cannot fully document what it owns or where much of its money went. No business, household, or other agency would be allowed to operate this way. On day one, an executive order directs a forensic audit of the department: not the routine annual review, but an investigation into where the money actually went, conducted by the Government Accountability Office and independent forensic accountants who report to Congress, not to the Pentagon. Any component of the department that cannot produce a clean audit by a defined deadline has its budget growth frozen until it can. This is not a

position on how large the military should be. It is a requirement that we know what we are paying for.

SECTION 4

Data

Privacy, Ownership, and the Digital Economy

Your Data Is Your Property

Personal data is legally redefined as Individual Intellectual Property (IIP). If a corporation wants to collect your data, it must obtain explicit opt-in consent. If it wants to use your data for any commercial purpose — training sets, data brokerage, targeted advertising, credit scoring, insurance underwriting, political targeting, employment screening, location tracking, behavioral profiling, health risk modeling, fraud detection sold as a service, or identity verification sold to third parties — it must pay you. Data used solely to fulfill a transaction you initiated (eg a shipping company using your address to deliver your package) is exempt; the moment that data is retained, aggregated, or sold beyond that purpose, the payment obligation applies. No consent, no collection. No payment, no use. Federal consent interface standards specify exactly what a compliant opt-in looks like — plain language, single click, no dark patterns — because corporate privacy compliance is a history of technically meeting the requirement while systematically defeating its purpose. Penalties for violation scale with company size and trigger divestiture proceedings for repeat violations. This will be called radical. So was the forty-hour work week.

MODs: Mediators of Data

A MOD is a federally chartered, worker-owned Data Union—a credit union for your digital identity. Every American is enrolled automatically at birth or naturalization, the same way Social Security works, and anyone who would rather manage their own data can opt out with one form. The MOD acts as a gatekeeper between your data and the corporations that want to use it, collecting micro-payments on your behalf every time your data is used. As AI becomes more sophisticated and more dependent on human-generated data, that payment goes up. You get a cut of the attention economy.
Important: The MODs are a payment system— a mechanism that collects micro-royalties on your behalf the same way ASCAP collects royalties for songwriters. They do not make policy decisions, allocate public resources, or determine eligibility for government programs. No algorithm decides what you are owed by the state, what laws apply to you, or what rights you have. The MODs negotiate for you. They don't govern you. Public interest data use — pandemic tracking, census counts, public health research — is exempt from payment obligations by statute.

The Data Dividend

The MODs dividend is not just a privacy protection. It is a small but growing income floor. The systems displacing workers in warehouses, call centers, and back offices are trained on human-generated data: conversations, decisions, patterns of behavior, lived experience accumulated over decades. That data has economic value. The people whose lives produced it are currently receiving nothing for it while the companies deploying those systems collect the returns. The MODs dividend corrects that. Your lived experience is the fuel for the systems that replaced you. Therefore, you get paid for it. It won't replace a paycheck. For most people it will be closer to a side hustle. But the principle is the point: you didn't make it, someone else generated it, so you pay for it. As automation accelerates, that payment goes up — compensation for a contribution that the machine economy could not function without.

The Data Strike

The MODs control the gate between your data and the corporations that profit from it. This is the plank that turns the gate into a lever. A verified petition against a specific corporation — modeled on the citizen referendum mechanism — forces mandatory review; cross the threshold, and MOD leadership must call a data strike, meaning data usage controlled by the MOD is no longer permitted until demands are met. The strike is announced before it takes effect, giving the company a window to reverse course; backing down ends it before a single record is withheld. Tier 1 is the default: consent revocation on non-critical data — targeting, profiling, ad data — the company loses what it uses to sell, not what keeps its lights on. Tier 2 requires a separate, higher-threshold vote, because it extends the strike to safety- and function-critical data — fraud detection, security infrastructure, anything that degrades without fresh input — and members voting for it are accepting that same exposure themselves. A strike that costs nothing isn't a strike. This is not stock manipulation, and consent that can never be withdrawn was never really consent — this is people exercising ownership over property that is legally theirs, the same way a labor strike is workers withholding labor that is legally theirs.

Government Surveillance: A High Bar

The surveillance architecture built after September 11th contained two distinct things that should not be treated as one. The first — breaking down the wall between domestic and foreign intelligence, allowing the FBI and CIA to share information, building fusion centers that let agencies coordinate on specific threats — addressed a real failure and belongs intact. The second — bulk collection of communications and metadata on millions of Americans who had done nothing — has not been justified by the evidence. The Privacy and Civil Liberties Oversight Board reviewed Section 215 in 2014 and concluded it had not been essential to preventing a single attack. A program that collected data on essentially every American for over a decade without demonstrable results is not a national security program. It is a surveillance infrastructure waiting for a future government to repurpose it. The audit standard is simple: every Patriot Act authority is reviewed against twenty-five years of operational data. What demonstrably contributed to preventing specific attacks stays, with proper warrant requirements attached. What didn't is nixed.

SECTION 5

Infrastructure

Grid, Rail, Housing, and Climate

Nationalizing the Energy Grid

Private utility companies operating as natural monopolies consistently prioritize shareholder dividends over grid resilience. The Texas grid failures and California wildfire blackouts are not anomalies—they are the logical outcome of applying a profit motive to essential public infrastructure. This is the one genuinely socialist policy in this platform, and it is justified on the same grounds that justify public ownership of roads, the military, and the postal service: natural monopolies are where markets structurally cannot function. When there is one grid and one set of power lines to your house, there is no competition to discipline prices or incentivize resilience — there is only a private company extracting rent from a captive customer base for infrastructure the country cannot survive without. The grid — the transmission lines and the local distribution wires that bring power to your house — is nationalized and operated as a non-profit federal utility. Power plants stay where competition actually works: they sell electricity into the public grid and compete on price. The profit margin disappears from the wires portion of every American's monthly electricity bill. The first order of business after nationalization is a full infrastructure audit — modernization, hardening against cyberattack and physical disruption, and buildout for renewable capacity. Private energy generation — rooftop solar, home batteries, community microgrids — is not only permitted but incentivized; the nationalized grid sets uniform, transparent interconnection standards so anyone can plug in without fighting a utility company's lawyers.

National High-Speed Maglev Rail

An (estimated) 10,000-mile high-speed maglev network connecting every major and mid-sized American city. Designed for operational speeds of 370-400mph, it fundamentally changes the geography of the American labor market. A worker who can get from a mid-sized Midwestern city to a major urban center in 30 minutes can access urban wages while paying rural housing costs. That is a more powerful housing intervention than any zoning reform ever proposed. It also gives every traveler a real alternative to flying, and forces the airlines to compete for the first time in a generation. The 10,000-mile network is a generational project, not a decade-long one. Initial high-priority corridors — the Northeast, the Pacific Coast, the Midwest triangle — reach operational capacity within ten years of groundbreaking. Full national buildout follows over twenty to thirty years, adjusted continuously based on construction progress, engineering realities, and evolving ridership data. The Interstate Highway System took over thirty-five years to complete. This is that project for the twenty-first century, and it is designed with a similar horizon.

The Neighborhood Renovation Initiative

The rail system is a long-term solution — its first corridors open about a decade after construction begins. The housing crisis is happening right now. The answer is not to keep spiraling outward — paving farmland, building car-dependent suburbs, extending the maintenance burden of infrastructure that will be abandoned in a generation. The answer is to go back and fix what already exists. A federal Neighborhood Renovation Initiative targets existing housing stock in depopulated post-industrial cities and

rural towns. Homeowners and community land trusts receive subsidized access to materials, technical assistance, and labor — drawn in part from the national service corps — to retrofit older homes with modern green technology: insulation, heat pumps, solar-ready electrical systems, weatherization. The program hits four targets at once: increase housing supply without sprawl, reduce energy costs for existing residents, build trades skills in the national service cohort, and revitalize communities the market has written off. Critically, the renovation investment arrives *before* the rail connection — so that when a stop comes to a smaller city, the people who stayed are positioned to benefit from rising property values rather than be displaced by them.

Homes Are for Living In

Wall Street figured out that houses are a great asset class, and families now bid against investment firms with bottomless cash. Any entity owning more than 100 single-family homes may not buy more. Algorithmic rent-setting software that lets landlords coordinate prices through a shared vendor is banned as price-fixing, which is what it is. Federal infrastructure and transit money goes first to communities that legalize duplexes, triplexes, and accessory units near transit, because the cheapest home to build is the one zoning currently forbids. Families compete with families for houses. Funds don't get a seat at the table.

Infrastructure Bonds

When concentrated capital attempts to crash the market in response to the 90/999 wealth cap—and it will—the government offers a National Security Bond Swap. Citizens can roll their declining 401(k)s into Infrastructure Bonds structured as Treasury securities, paying a guaranteed return equal to the Treasury's own inflation-protected rate plus a small premium, safer than the market and tied to something real. Your retirement is no longer tied to a hedge fund's speculative bets. It is tied to the tracks under the train and the wires of the grid. The people engineering the crash cannot weaponize a market you've already left.

Community Gardens

Knowing how to grow food should be as universal as knowing how to read. And for most of human history, it was. Community gardens—seeded and staffed in part by national service participants—are established in every American neighborhood, with priority given to food deserts. The goal is practical: supplement the food system, rebuild food literacy, and remove hunger as a lever that capital holds over labor. When the ultra-processed food regulations kick in and the industrial food supply starts to change, people will need to know how to grow their own food. What the neighborhoods do with what they grow is up to them— they can either eat it themselves or sell it.

Climate: The Platform Is Already Climate Policy

This platform does not need a separate climate ideology. The nationalized grid, the maglev rail network, and the neighborhood renovation initiative are collectively a larger climate intervention than most dedicated climate legislation has ever proposed, and none of them require anyone to adopt a climate identity to support them. Cheap renewable electricity makes electrification of everything economically rational. Ten thousand miles of electric rail replaces millions of daily car trips. What gets added here is pricing what has been free: carbon externalities — the costs imposed by fossil fuel combustion on public health and future generations — are currently unpriced,

which means they are subsidized by everyone except the companies producing them. A carbon border tariff on imports from countries without equivalent standards corrects that market distortion. This is not a tax on American consumers. It is the removal of a century-long subsidy to the wrong industries.

Third Places

America has a loneliness problem. The only real solution we have is each other. A third place is anywhere that isn't home and isn't work: the library, the park, the diner, the bowling alley, the barbershop. The sociologist Ray Oldenburg called them the heart of a community, and they are disappearing, replaced by spaces optimized for consumption and transactions rather than human connection. This platform rebuilds them on two fronts. First, public ones: federal funding for libraries, parks, recreation centers, and community halls, with priority for towns that have lost theirs. Second, private ones: a voluntary Third Place Certification for any business that chooses to act like a community anchor. To qualify, a business commits to at least three of the following: welcoming long stays with no pressure to leave, hosting free regular community events, offering free meeting space to local groups, keeping a phone-free area or phone-free hours, or staying open as a gathering place in the evenings or on weekends. Certified businesses receive a two-year federal tax holiday on food and beverage revenue, and a reduced rate in years three and four, renewed annually based on what they actually do. Schools across the country are already going phone-free, and concerts and comedy clubs lock phones at the door because audiences like it better. Nobody has to give up their phone to have a place to go. The point is that there should be places worth putting it down for. You can't mandate community. You can make room for it.

Local News and Media Ownership

A democracy requires an informed public. Local news is how most people learn what their city council is doing, whether their school board is spending money correctly, and who is actually running for what. It is also disappearing. Hedge funds and media conglomerates — Sinclair Broadcasting being the most aggressive example — have spent the last two decades buying up local television stations and newspapers, gutting their newsrooms, and either running them as content farms or killing them entirely. The result is news deserts: counties and communities with no meaningful local journalism and no institutional accountability for local power. Broadcast consolidators like Sinclair are Tier 1 Monopoly designations. The national ownership cap drops from 39% of American households to 25%, no company may own more than one of the top four stations in any local market, and the ownership limits loosened over the last two decades are restored.Financial entities — private equity firms, hedge funds — are prohibited from acquiring news organizations above a defined threshold size. This is done on the same logic that removes them from hospice and elder care: you cannot optimize for quarterly returns and for public accountability journalism at the same time. On the affirmative side: federal grants and low-interest loans are made available for locally owned, independent news outlets. Worker-owned and nonprofit newsroom cooperatives receive priority. A federal shield law protects journalists — staff and freelance — from being compelled to reveal sources. Existing public media funding is reoriented toward local stations rather than national programming, which already has enough platforms. What gets built again is the institution that tells you what is happening in your town — and holds the people running it accountable.

SECTION 6

Technology

AI Accountability, Big Tech, and the Rules of the New Digital Age

AI Is a Product, Not a Person.

Artificial intelligence systems are not persons. They are machines. They do not have rights. They are products — subject to product liability standards. The manufacturer or deployer bears full legal responsibility for foreseeable harms. Section 230's liability shield does not apply to AI-generated content, or to content a platform's own algorithms choose to amplify. Passive hosting of what users post keeps its protection; once a company's system decides what you see, the company owns that decision. A single federal statute establishes all of these rules. The question of machine consciousness is worth scientific investigation; it is not worth allowing corporations to use it to escape accountability for products they build and sell.

Consumer AI Protections

AI products are regulated on the supply side, not just the consumer side. Specifically prohibited design patterns include: anthropomorphic design engineered to cause users to mistake an AI system for a human relationship; sycophantic feedback loops designed to maximize engagement through emotional validation rather than accuracy; memory systems designed to cultivate dependency rather than serve the user's stated goals; and any design feature whose primary measurable function is to increase session length at the expense of user wellbeing. These are product safety questions, treated as such under the product liability framework. AI products accessible to minors are subject to mandatory age verification, independent child safety review, and a heightened liability standard: any harm to a minor from a prohibited design pattern is a strict liability offense. You built it. You own what it did.

Breaking Up Big Tech

Amazon, Google, Meta, and Apple are the most obvious Tier 1 Monopoly designations. The structural problem is the same in each case: you cannot own the infrastructure, the product, and the marketplace simultaneously. Amazon cannot own the marketplace, the logistics network, the cloud infrastructure competitors depend on, and the private-label products competing on its own platform. Google cannot own search, the ad exchange that monetizes it, the browser most people use to reach it, and the AI systems replacing it. A company forced to divest its dominant platform cannot use that platform to colonize AI. Divestiture is paired with an interoperability mandate: dominant platforms must let users take their data, contacts, and content to a competitor, and must let competing services connect on fair terms, so the network effects that built the monopoly stop working as a moat. The compute infrastructure that a handful of companies currently control is subject to the same concentration analysis as any other infrastructure market.

Existential Risk: Fund the Science, Negotiate the Treaty

There is no scientific consensus on catastrophic AI risk. There should be. We need to fund the answer at the scale of the Manhattan Project, insulated from industry capture. An international treaty modeled on nuclear nonproliferation — with mandatory

safety testing, verification, and graduated consequences for defection — is built in parallel. We move at the speed of getting it right.

Automation Notice

Companies already have to give sixty days' notice before mass layoffs. When a company with over 1,000 employees replaces fifty or more workers with automated systems, notice extends to 180 days, the company funds retraining for every displaced worker at a community college or trade program, and the displacement is reported publicly. You can automate. You can't do it to people in the dark.

Data Centers Pay Their Own Way

AI runs on data centers, and data centers run on enormous amounts of electricity and water. When they arrive, the cost of new power plants and transmission lines often lands on every household's electric bill. Under this platform, data centers pay the full cost of the grid capacity they require, disclose their energy and water use publicly, and cannot receive local tax breaks unless the community votes on them. The nationalized grid serves them like any other customer. Residential ratepayers never subsidize them.

Workplace Surveillance

Keystroke loggers, webcam monitoring, productivity scores, and algorithmic discipline have turned many jobs into constant surveillance. Employers must disclose every monitoring tool they use. Monitoring off the clock and on personal devices is banned. No worker is disciplined or fired by an algorithm without a human review they can see and contest. Your employer bought your time, not your entire life.

Surveillance Pricing is Outlawed

Companies increasingly use personal data to charge different people different prices for the same product: more if your phone is new, more if you've searched for it twice, more if the algorithm thinks you're desperate. Prices based on personal data are banned. The price is the price, for everyone.

Deepfakes and Digital Consent

Federal law now requires platforms to remove nonconsensual intimate images, including AI-generated ones. That protection extends to anyone's voice and likeness used commercially without consent, and AI-generated political ads must say so on screen, in plain language, for their full length. Your face and your voice belong to you.

Bots Can’t Pose as People

Automation isn't the problem. Search engines, accessibility tools and emergency alerts are all bots. Deception is. It is illegal for an automated account to present itself as a human being, and it’s illegal to run networks of automated accounts to fake public opinion, fake demand, or fake a crowd. Every automated account, including an AI agent acting for a person, must be labeled as one. Large platforms must offer a verified-human option: you prove once, through the same identity system used for digital voting, that you're a real person, and the platform learns only that you passed, not who you are. Your account can be anonymous. It can't be fake. Anyone can choose to see only verified humans. Platforms above a size threshold that don't detect, label and remove undisclosed bot networks face penalties scaled to revenue. This is a rule about

honesty, not content: no one's speech is removed for what it says. The people who buy the fake crowd are as liable as the people who sell it. Buying bot followers, engagement or reviews to move a sale or an election carries civil penalties, and campaigns, PACs and their vendors face election-law penalties. The operator behind an undisclosed bot network is liable for what it does. Foreign operators are reached the way every other foreign fraud is: through the platforms, ad networks and payment processors that move the money.

Broadband for Everyone

Many states ban cities and towns from building their own internet service, a rule written for incumbent providers. Those bans are preempted. Any community can build public or cooperative broadband, and federal funds prioritize places where one company has the market to itself. Internet access is infrastructure, the same as roads and power lines.

SECTION 7

Constitution

Continuing What the Founders Started

Strike the Penal Servitude Clause from the 13th Amendment

The 13th Amendment abolished slavery—except as punishment for crime. Those seventeen words— "except as a punishment for crime whereof the party shall have been duly convicted"— are the legal foundation of prison labor. They are why incarceration functions as a mechanism to extract cheap or free labor from a population disproportionately poor and disproportionately imprisoned because of mandatory minimum sentencing this platform abolishes. Strike the words. Slavery and involuntary servitude are prohibited.

Reverse Citizens United and Buckley v. Valeo

Corporations are not people. Money is not speech for purposes of the First Amendment. A constitutional amendment establishes both. Congress retains full authority to regulate campaign finance. This does not silence any human voice. It removes the megaphone that concentrated wealth has purchased at the expense of every other voice in the room.

Pure National Popular Vote

Whoever gets the most votes wins. No electors. No allocation formula. Wyoming's 580,000 voters matter exactly as much per person as California's 39 million. One person, one vote. The National Popular Vote Interstate Compact serves as the interim mechanism while the amendment campaign builds momentum.

Clean Elections

Elections are publicly financed. Every registered voter receives a voucher — $100— to contribute to candidates of their choice. Individual contributions are capped at $500. Small dollar donations are publicly matched to ensure that a candidate who earns broad grassroots support can compete without a donor class behind them. Every dollar is fully disclosed. The system is administered by an independent federal body structured like the Federal Reserve — fixed terms, statutory independence, no executive discretion over disbursement — so that no administration of either party can weaponize election funding against its opponents. These rules apply to every election in the United States, federal through local, beginning with federal races. The constitutional amendment that makes this possible also kills Citizens United, Buckley v. Valeo, and the money-is-speech doctrine that built the auction. Every voice counts the same.

Lobbying Enforcement

Every reform in this section can be quietly undone by the people paid to undo it. Federal law already requires lobbyists to register and disclose who pays them and what they are lobbying on, but compliance is largely self-reported, and enforcement depends on referrals to a single U.S. Attorney's office that has brought very few cases. This platform creates an independent federal lobbying enforcement agency with dedicated funding, subpoena power, and the authority to audit disclosures, investigate undisclosed influence campaigns, and refer violations for criminal prosecution. Its di-

rector is elected nationally on a nonpartisan ballot to a single fixed term, so the agency answers to voters rather than to the administration or the industries it oversees. Influence is not illegal. Hidden influence should be.

Digital Voting Option

Estonia has run national digital elections since 2005 with zero successful attacks on election integrity in twenty years. The United States runs digital banking, digital tax filing, and digital Social Security administration — the verified identity infrastructure already exists. Requiring Americans to appear in person on a single Tuesday to exercise their most fundamental right is an artifact of 1845 legislation written when travel by horse made same-day voting the only option. It is not a security feature. It is a barrier. Federal elections move to a secure digital platform with a paper audit trail, administered by the same identity verification infrastructure the IRS already uses. Turnout is the point. Higher turnout means more representative government. The people who benefit from low turnout will call this unsafe. They are the reason it isn't already done.

Gerrymandering

Gerrymandering is how the majority gets ignored. It is the mechanism by which a party that loses the popular vote statewide can win a supermajority of the seats, by which incumbents choose their voters rather than voters choosing their representatives, and by which every reform this platform proposes can be blocked indefinitely by a legislature that does not reflect the people it claims to represent. It is the lock on the door. District boundaries are determined by population, derived from the federal census, with compactness and respect for existing municipal and county boundaries as binding secondary criteria — and nothing else. Not party registration, not voting history, not incumbent protection. No map may be drawn to weaken the voting power of any community of voters, and the Voting Rights Act is restored in full (see below). Redistricting happens every ten years on the census cycle, conducted by an independent commission of randomly selected citizens drawn from a pool of registered voters with no current or prior political office or party employment — chosen the way jurors are chosen, because the people who benefit from rigged maps should not be the people drawing them. Maps produced by any other method are not legal maps. The Supreme Court declined to set a constitutional standard for partisan gerrymandering in Rucho v. Common Cause and explicitly invited Congress to act by statute. This platform accepts that invitation. You do not get to draw your own district.

Restore the Voting Rights Act

In 2013 the Supreme Court struck down the formula that decided which places needed federal approval before changing their voting rules, and in 2026 it narrowed the law's ban on discriminatory maps. Both rulings left Congress an opening to write the rules again. This platform does. Any state or county with a recent record of voting-rights violations must get federal approval before changing its voting rules. The list updates on a rolling basis, so it follows behavior, not geography or history, and any place can earn its way off it by staying clean. The ban on rules and maps that shut voters out of fair representation is restored to what Congress wrote in 1982: if a rule or map has that effect, it's illegal, whether or not anyone can prove what was in a legislator's head. Every eligible citizen is registered automatically through the same ID system used for digital voting. The right to vote shouldn't depend on which county you live in.

Citizen Referendum

Protests have no teeth if the people in charge can simply ignore them. Millions can gather and nothing changes because the legal architecture gives them no lever to pull. This platform creates one. A federal citizen referendum mechanism — triggered by a verified petition of five percent of the national electorate within a 180-day window — places any federal law, executive action, or constitutional question directly on the ballot at the next federal election. It is not purely advisory. A referendum that passes by majority becomes binding instruction to Congress with a mandatory response deadline. A second mechanism — the legislative injunction — allows a verified petition to suspend implementation of a specific federal action for 90 days while the referendum process determines the public's will. These are the legal levers that make the threat of revolution unnecessary. The Founders gave us a republic. This gives the republic its emergency brake. Referendum campaigns, petition drives included, fall under the same Clean Elections rules as candidates: capped contributions, full disclosure, public matching for small donors. The emergency brake belongs to the people, not to whoever can afford to pay signature gatherers. Because one Congress can't bind the next by ordinary law, the binding version is enacted by constitutional amendment; until then, it operates as a mandatory vote and public response."

Supreme Court Reform

The Supreme Court has nine justices serving lifetime appointments selected entirely by the president and confirmed by the Senate — a body that, thanks to gerrymandering and the Electoral College, may not reflect the popular will at all. The result is a court whose composition can be determined by which party controls the White House during a vacancy, producing a judicial philosophy that outlasts the voters who produced it by decades. Justices serve a single eighteen-year term, staggered so that each presidential term produces exactly two appointments — removing the actuarial lottery from constitutional law. The President nominates; the Senate confirms; but the confirmation requires a national popular ratification vote at the next federal election before the justice is seated. Every eight years, the public may trigger a retention vote on any sitting justice through the same petition mechanism as the citizen referendum — a justice who fails retention is replaced through the standard nomination process. Finally, no justice serves past age 75. Because these changes alter the tenure the Constitution sets for federal judges, they are enacted by constitutional amendment.

Age Cap: Senate and Supreme Court

No person over the age of 75 serves in the United States Senate or on the Supreme Court. This is not a judgment about any individual's capabilities — it is an acknowledgment that the people making decisions about the next fifty years of American life should have a personal stake in what those fifty years look like. The science on cognitive aging is consistent: processing speed, working memory, and cognitive flexibility decline measurably with age regardless of individual variation. The federal government already accepts this principle — commercial airline pilots must retire at 65. We are applying a less stringent standard to jobs with more consequence. Senators and justices who reach 75 complete their current term and retire with full benefits. The same standard applies to the presidency — no person over the age of 75 may be inaugurated to a new term. The Constitution sets the qualifications for these offices, and the Supreme Court has held that Congress cannot add to them by statute, so the age cap is enacted by constitutional amendment.

SECTION 8

Rights and Accountability

A Few Other Things That Need Updating

National Ranked Choice Voting

Ranked choice voting is implemented nationally for all federal elections. By eliminating the spoiler effect and allowing voters to express genuine preferences without fear of wasting their vote, RCV opens space for coalitions that the current binary system cannot accommodate. It is the reform that makes all the other reforms in this platform politically possible. The objection that it is too complicated is answered by the countries and American cities that already use it without incident. The only real objection is that it threatens the two-party duopoly, which does. These reforms apply to federal elections first — Congress has the authority to implement them without negotiating with fifty state legislatures simultaneously. States and localities are encouraged to follow, and any state that adopts RCV, independent redistricting, and digital voting infrastructure for its own elections receives full federal reimbursement for the transition costs. The carrot is funding. The stick is contrast — voters who experience a functional federal election will notice when their state elections still run on the old system, and they will ask why. The reform spreads by example.

Criminal Justice: End the Prison Pipeline

Mandatory minimum sentencing for non-violent offenses is abolished in the federal system, and federal justice funding goes to states that do the same. Judges get their discretion back. Cash bail is eliminated — you do not sit in jail before conviction because you cannot afford to pay your way out. Pre-trial detention is based on demonstrated flight risk or danger to others, not on your bank account. Private prisons become publicly operated. The default shifts to rehabilitation: education, job training, mental health treatment, genuine reintegration. Capital punishment stays but the standard requires DNA evidence directly linking the convicted individual to the killing. The 13th Amendment penal servitude clause— see Section 7 — is struck, removing the financial incentive for mass incarceration. And finally, charging decisions for serious offenses are subject to independent review. The data on how this system operates — conviction rates, racial disparities, plea deal rates — is published annually in a standardized federal format. The justice system is never perfect, and this data makes its failures visible and its next reforms undeniable.

Capital Punishment

The DNA-only standard determines who is eligible for execution. For those who are, this is how it happens and who has final say. Nitrogen asphyxiation is the default method — painless, reliable, and requiring no pharmaceutical supply chain. Any other method requires an affirmative request from the prisoner. The moment the prosecution announces it will seek capital punishment, the victim's family designates one representative. In cases with two or more unrelated victims, no single family can speak for all of them, and those executions proceed as standard state-administered executions with families retaining full witness rights. When the execution date is set, that representative has two options: stand back and let the sentence carry out, or exercise veto power and convert the sentence to life without parole. This is not a requirement placed on families — it is an option held open for them. A life was taken. Those most affected should have final say in what comes next.

Gun Rights: The Social Voucher

The Second Amendment stands. A person buying their first firearm provides three personal references: people who have known them for at least five years, are not relatives or current romantic partners, and will answer one question from the dealer: are you comfortable with this person buying a firearm? A reference who can't be reached is replaced with another; only an actual "no" stops the sale. Once vouched for, a buyer is cleared for ten years of purchases with the standard background check alone. Anyone who already owns firearms when this law takes effect is grandfathered: a dealer receipt, a prior carry permit, or a hunting license history is enough, and no new federal list is created to check it. Someone without three eligible references, after a move or an estrangement, can substitute a documented attestation from a current employer or a licensed medical or mental health professional. A reference who knowingly certifies "yes" while aware of a documented risk they didn't disclose is liable the same way a straw purchaser is. Nobody is liable for what they couldn't have known. This won't stop every act of gun violence, and it isn't designed to. It closes one specific gap: the first-time buyer with no disqualifying record who is visibly isolated from the people around them. That gap is real, and current law does nothing about it. The thirty-year hunter is not the gap, and this law leaves him alone.

NICS Reporting Enforcement

The background check system already on the books only works if the disqualifying records are actually seen. Several mass shootings of the last two decades happened because a disqualifying record existed and was never reported into NICS, not because no mechanism existed to catch it. States and federal agencies are mandated to report disqualifying records — domestic violence convictions, involuntary commitments, restraining orders — within a fixed window, with funding tied to compliance and penalties for agencies that don't.

Reproductive Rights

This platform holds that abortion ends a human life. It also holds that the decision belongs to the woman and her doctor — and that these two positions are not contradictory. The circumstances of individual pregnancies are so varied and so personal that no legislature or court is competent to evaluate them from the outside. This is state-sanctioned ending of a human life, and it is not meted out casually — which is why this platform is committed to making it rare through every available means short of coercion. Comprehensive, evidence-based sex education is federally funded. Contraception is covered. Paid family leave, subsidized childcare, housing stability, and universal healthcare mean that no woman is making this decision because society failed to provide reasonable support. Adoption is faster, cheaper, and better supported for everyone involved. Every option, before and during and after pregnancy, is resourced and presented without judgment. When prevention fails, when circumstances make continuation impossible, when the decision has been made by the only two people qualified to make it — the procedure is available, safe, and legal throughout pregnancy, with the physician applying standard medical judgment. We do everything in our power to make it unnecessary. We do not pretend that power is unlimited. That decision belongs in the exam room, not in a statute.

Marijuana and Psilocybin

Marijuana is legalized federally, with immediate expungement of all prior convictions for possession and non-violent distribution, and licensing frameworks designed to

prevent the legal market from being captured by the same corporations that dominate tobacco and alcohol. Psilocybin is decriminalized and the research moratorium that has blocked serious clinical investigation for fifty years is lifted. Early results for treatment-resistant depression, PTSD, and addiction are compelling enough that continued prohibition of research is scientifically indefensible. We follow the data.

Legalization of Sex Work

Decriminalization and regulated legalization of sex work, modeled on evidence from New Zealand and similar jurisdictions. Decriminalization demonstrably reduces violence against sex workers, improves health outcomes, and allows workers to access legal protections. The current criminalized model does not reduce sex work. It makes it more dangerous for the people doing it. Harm reduction is the operative principle. The morality of the transaction is not the government's business. The safety of the people involved is.

Fan-Owned Professional Sports Teams

The NFL's ban on community-owned professional sports franchises is overturned. The Green Bay Packers model—a community-owned, non-profit team that cannot be relocated by a billionaire owner chasing a stadium subsidy—is made legally available to any city for any sport. The current model is a cartel protecting asset appreciation for billionaire owners at the expense of communities that have built their cultural identity around these teams. You do not get to hold a city hostage for a publicly funded stadium and then move the team anyway. The community that built the fanbase owns a piece of it. The objection that community ownership can't survive real economic pressure has been answered for a hundred years. The Packers have been community-owned since 1923. Their structure was built specifically to prevent corporatization and relocation: shares can't be sold for profit, no individual can accumulate a controlling stake, and if the team ever dissolved the assets would go to a local charity — not to shareholders. They survived the Depression, the Cold War, the Digital Revolution, and a century of NFL consolidation under billionaire ownership. They're still in Green Bay. The model works. And because no single entity holds a controlling stake, community-owned franchises are structurally exempt from Tier 1 divestiture.

IRS Pre-Filing

This one is simple. The IRS already has your W-2. Your employer sent it. For the vast majority of Americans the IRS could send you a completed tax return. You check it, sign it, done. Fifteen minutes. No cost. This system exists in Norway, Denmark, Sweden, and Japan. The reason it does not exist here is that Intuit spent decades lobbying specifically to prevent it, at one point inserting language directly into IRS appropriations bills. Enough.

Direct Auto Sales: Outlaw the Middleman

State franchise laws that prohibit automobile manufacturers from selling directly to consumers exist for one reason: car dealerships lobbied for them. There is no consumer protection rationale for requiring a middleman in a transaction between a willing buyer and a willing seller. There is no safety argument. There is no market efficiency argument — the opposite is true. The mandatory dealership model adds thousands of dollars to the cost of every car sold in America, creates a negotiation environment that a majority of buyers report as among the most stressful financial transactions of their lives, and concentrates profit in an intermediary layer that contributes

nothing to the design, manufacture, or quality of the vehicle. Federal law preempts state franchise protections that prohibit direct manufacturer-to-consumer sales. You can still buy from a dealer if you want to. You can also buy directly. The manufacturer decides how to sell its product. The dealership lobby does not decide for them.

Ultra-Processed Food Regulation

Ultra-processed food is human cattle feed and should be regulated like tobacco. Not taxed, regulated. A tax without changing availability is a penalty on poverty. Regulation that changes what can be manufactured attacks the supply side where the problem originates. The target is the industrial food system, not the person who can only afford what the food desert stocks. It is also worth noting that food is the one cost the government uses to calculate whether someone qualifies for assistance — and the one cost that has been kept artificially cheap through industrial processing while everything else— housing, healthcare, utilities— has been allowed to spiral. Paired with a national community garden initiative and food literacy programs, this is a generational intervention in American public health.

Farmers, Not Cartels

Speaking of food, four companies control most of the American beef market. Ranchers get less for their cattle, shoppers pay more at the counter, and a single plant fire can shake prices nationwide. The big four meatpackers are Tier 1 Monopoly designations, and the 25% rule's review applies to poultry, pork, seed, and fertilizer the same as it applies to tech. The Packers and Stockyards Act, written in 1921 to break up the original Beef Trust, is enforced again. Farmers get the right to repair their own equipment without a dealer's permission or a manufacturer's software lock. Country-of-origin labeling returns, so "Product of USA" means it was born and raised here.

Foster Care

The foster care system removes children from their families at rates that reflect poverty more than danger. A parent who can't afford food or heat is not the same as a parent who abuses or neglects their child, and this platform requires the system to treat them differently — resources first, removal only if the safety issue isn't resolved within 72 hours. When a relative steps up, they receive the same financial support as a licensed stranger: a Family Preservation Credit sufficient to ensure the kinship home isn't pushed into poverty by the addition of the child. The current system pays $3,000 a month to a stranger and $0 to the grandmother — that is a market failure and this platform corrects it. Recovery homes for trafficking survivors are funded on outcomes, not procedural compliance, with independent advocates replacing institutional box-checking as the oversight mechanism. Private equity case management is out; public agencies with manageable caseloads are in. The aging out crisis is addressed by the platform's existing planks — the $25 minimum wage, Medicare for All, and the national service program exist for the kid who grew up in the system too. Most of what fills the foster care pipeline is poverty, and most of this platform is focused on poverty alleviation. More than half of minors recovered from sex trafficking corridors in the United States were in foster care before they were trafficked. The foster care system as currently designed is a trafficking pipeline. That is what the evidence says, and that is what this platform is built to end.

Elder Care, Hospice, and the Dignity of Dying

America has a cultural problem with death. We treat dying as a medical failure rather than a human inevitability, which is why end-of-life care is designed around prolonging life at any cost rather than around the quality of whatever time remains. The result is a system of nursing homes and memory care units and hospice facilities that function as holding rooms for the dying. We have simply not bothered to make them good environments because we don't like thinking about it happening to us (even though some version of it will). This platform changes that on two fronts. First, hospice and elder care facilities are removed from the private equity ownership model — the same logic that this platform applies to private prisons. You cannot optimize for quarterly returns and for dying with dignity at the same time. Worker-governed cooperative facilities, funded through Medicare, become the default model. Second, the United States funds federal pilot programs modeled on Hogewey — the Dutch dementia village outside Amsterdam where residents live in a genuine community: real homes, a supermarket, a café, a theater, caregivers who don't wear uniforms. Outcomes on quality of life, medication use, and longevity compared to traditional memory care are significantly better. Florida and Arizona would be logical starting points given their elder populations. The objection that this shuttles people into a simulated reality answers itself: we already do that. Hogewey just makes it humane. The goal is a society that confronts death honestly, gives the people nearest it genuine dignity and agency, and stops treating the end of life as a revenue opportunity.

SECTION 9

Immigration

A Secure, Dignified Approach

Employer Accountability

Undocumented immigration persists primarily because American industries depend on it — agriculture, construction, hospitality, and food processing have employed undocumented workers for decades specifically because those workers can be paid below minimum wage and threatened with deportation if they complain. Border security matters; any idiot can see that. But this is a labor market problem deliberately preserved by the same industries that yell loudest about it while blocking every enforcement mechanism that would help solve it. The enforcement target is the employer, not the worker. E-Verify has existed since 1996 and has never been made mandatory — that is not an oversight. Knowingly hiring undocumented workers becomes a federal felony, not a fine that amounts to a cost of doing business. A two-year transition window runs simultaneously: employers who move undocumented workers into an expedited legal visa pathway during that window face civil penalties only. The goal is to collapse the shadow labor market without triggering a food supply crisis — phased enforcement makes that possible. The legal immigration process is reformed to be fast and functional, visa categories are updated for the actual economy, and the DREAM Act is passed. The 700,000 people protected under DACA were brought here as children, educated in American schools, and have worked here their entire adult lives — this is the only country most of them have ever known. No more industry profiting from a shadow second-class workforce while politicians use those same workers as a cultural wedge, and the workers themselves live outside the reach of every labor protection this platform establishes.

Enforcement Accountability

A federal badge is not a license to operate outside the law, and an agency that investigates itself when something goes wrong is not accountability, it's cover. Immigration enforcement is split into two clearly separated functions: a division focused on national security threats, cartel activity, and violent crime, and a separate, unarmed civil branch that handles visa processing and paperwork compliance. You do not send a tactical team to audit a landscaping crew's I-9 forms. Every field agent wears a body camera, full stop, and failure to activate it during an enforcement action is treated as a serious violation. When an agency action results in injury or death, the agency does not investigate itself and does not get to fast-track the deportation of witnesses before they can testify — an independent civilian oversight board and the Department of Justice take jurisdiction immediately. None of this weakens enforcement. It makes it legitimate.

Clear the Backlog

The immigration court backlog is the predictable result of decades of underfunding a system everyone agreed was important but nobody wanted to pay for. Millions of cases are currently pending, with average wait times stretching past two years in many jurisdictions — years in which people exist in a legal gray zone, unable to plan a life, while the backlog itself becomes unmanageable. Treat it like the logistics problem it is. A massive surge in immigration judges and asylum officers, funded at the scale the caseload actually requires, turns years-long limbo into weeks-long resolution. Digi-

tized case processing, biometric verification, and modernized tracking replace a system still leaning on paperwork and mail. The standard is simple: if a claim is denied, removal follows promptly under due process. If a claim is approved, the person is documented and working, not floating in administrative purgatory for a decade. An immigration system this dysfunctional doesn't happen by accident. It happens because a broken system is more politically useful than a functional one.

Border Enforcement

Border security spending should follow the evidence. The government's own data — DEA testimony to Congress, CBP seizure records — shows that the overwhelming majority of fentanyl entering the country comes through official ports of entry, hidden in passenger vehicles and commercial cargo. Most of the people convicted of smuggling it are U.S. citizens, not migrants. That is where the actual narcotics threat is concentrated, and that is where enforcement resources should be concentrated: advanced scanning technology, expanded personnel, and real inspection capacity at the ports themselves. Across the rest of the border, replace the fantasy of a wall spanning thousands of miles of desert with actual situational awareness — surveillance towers, sensors, and drones that tell Border Patrol agents where something is actually happening, instead of spreading them thin across terrain and hoping they're able to handle it. This is not open borders. It's the difference between enforcement that responds to evidence and enforcement that responds to a slogan. And it pairs with other proposals in this section— the more the legal pathway actually works, the less incentive anyone has to move people through smuggling networks between the ports in the first place.

Legal Pathways

If the legal way in takes fifteen years and the illegal way in takes a bus ticket, you already know which one people are going to use. Visa caps are currently set by politicians and are frozen at numbers that have nothing to do with the actual economy. This platform ties them to real-time Department of Labor data instead: when a sector — agriculture, construction, hospitality — has a documented labor shortage, a corresponding number of provisional work visas opens up automatically, no act of Congress required for every adjustment. The visa belongs to the worker, not the employer who sponsored it. An employer who underpays, abuses, or threatens a visa holder loses that worker to a competitor, immediately, by right — which means the employer loses the leverage that made exploitation profitable in the first place. That is what actually protects American wages: not a wall, but removing the ability of any employer to hold a worker hostage with the threat of deportation. A functioning legal market starves the black market of the demand that built it.

PART IV

How Is This Implemented?

A Note on Sequencing and Velocity

The staged structure of this implementation plan is deliberate velocity management. It's designed around one principle: change that outruns public support can't survive. In other words, if people can't see policy bettering their lives in real time, it's easier to convince them it's failed entirely or not worth implementing. The Term 1 items are specifically chosen because they are immediately achievable, immediately felt by the people they benefit, and difficult to reverse once enacted. For example, Medicare for All builds a constituency of everyone who has it. The more structurally disruptive changes — the co-op transitions, the trust-busting divestitures — are in Term 2 precisely because they require the political durability the first wave of reforms builds. It's reconstruction, sequenced so that the building remains habitable throughout.

None of this platform means anything without a theory of power. The assumption here is a genuine mandate: the presidency, a House majority, and a Senate majority large enough to eliminate the filibuster. That last condition is the prerequisite everything else depends on. A Senate that can be blocked by 41 votes is a Senate that cannot pass a minimum wage increase, let alone codetermination or Medicare for All. The filibuster goes on day one of the new Senate session. Everything below assumes it does.

Who Does What

The Constitution divides power between Washington and the states, and this platform respects that line. It has to, because the courts will enforce it whether we like it or not. Every plank falls into one of three categories.

Federal law, directly

These are powers the Constitution gives Congress outright: taxes, interstate commerce, antitrust, banking, labor law, the minimum wage, Social Security, Medicare, immigration, federal elections, federal courts and prisons, and the interstate power grid. Medicare for All, the wage floor, card check, codetermination, the wealth cap, the transaction tax, Glass-Steagall, data ownership, monopoly breakups, the Social Security cap, Clean Elections for federal races, and the federal pieces of criminal justice reform all happen here, by statute.

Corporate charters are issued by the states, so the Corporate Kill-Switch and codetermination come with a federal charter requirement for corporations above the 1,000-employee threshold, an idea already proposed in Congress in 2018. A company that size operates in a national market, and it answers to national rules.

Federal money, with conditions

Schools, local policing, state courts, zoning, foster care, and state elections belong to the states. Here the federal government does what it has always done: it pays, and it attaches conditions to the payment. The teacher pay floor, teacher-governed schools, cash bail and mandatory minimum reform in state courts, the zoning incentives, community college, childcare, foster care reform, and the state election reforms all work this way. The Supreme Court has ruled that Washington can't threaten money

states already depend on to force their hand, so every condition here is attached to new money. States that take it get the funding and follow the rules. States that refuse keep the old system, and their voters get to compare.

Constitutional amendments

Some changes can't be made by statute at all: striking the penal servitude clause, reversing Citizens United, the national popular vote, the age cap, Supreme Court term limits and ratification votes, and the binding citizen referendum. These are the long campaigns, and the platform treats them that way.

No reform here depends on pretending the states don't exist. Most of the country's best ideas started in a state that went first. This platform gives states a reason to go first, and the money to do it.

The meta-strategy throughout is velocity and communication. Move faster than opposition can organize. Explain everything in plain language before opponents can frame it. Build constituencies with every bill that passes so that each reform creates defenders of the next one. FDR's first 100 days established the template: arrive with a mandate, use it immediately, and get ahead of the narrative before your opponents define it for you.

Term 1: The Foundation

The first term begins with everything that doesn't require Congress.

On day one, executive orders direct the DOJ to begin preparing Tier 1 Monopoly designations, the FTC to halt all pending media consolidation deals, the IRS to begin rebuilding enforcement capacity using existing appropriations, and the Pentagon to begin the forensic audit. None of this requires legislation. All of it signals immediately that this administration means what it said.

Then, a direct-to-camera address to the country — not a press conference, not a photo op — explaining in plain language what is about to happen and why. Again, FDR's lesson: get ahead of the narrative before your opponents frame it for you. The people who will fight this will call it radical, socialist, and dangerous. Address that first. Then explain what will actually be happening.

The filibuster is eliminated on day one of the new Senate session by simple majority vote. This will be the most contested procedural move of the term. It happens first because nothing else on this list is possible without it.

The legislative blitz begins with the things that have the broadest immediate public benefit and the clearest constituencies:

The **$25 minimum wage** with phased five-year implementation and inflation indexing active from day one — every working person feels this coming, and the constituency for defending it begins building the moment it passes.

Medicare for All with the four-year transition clock — the end date is set in legislation and does not move, the constituency for protecting it starts forming immediately.

Cash bail elimination and **mandatory minimum abolition** for non-violent offenses — popular across party lines, costs nothing to pass, felt immediately by people who have been living under both.

IRS pre-filing — the only serious opposition is Intuit and H&R Block, and you dare them to publicly argue that Americans should keep paying $150 to file a return the government could send them for free.

The Social Security cap is lifted — the program's long-range shortfall shrinks by two-thirds in one vote, and every worker sees the CEO pay the same rate they do.

Right to repair and country-of-origin labeling — cheap, popular in farm country, and felt the next time a tractor breaks down.

Poverty line replacement is enacted in the same session — the SPM becomes the official measure, and the new wage and benefit floors this platform proposes are measured against reality instead of a 1963 formula. Because many programs use the poverty line to decide who qualifies, an honest line means more families qualify for help. That is the point, and it has a real cost, so programs recalibrate on a phased schedule matched to the revenue coming in, with the full cost scored and published before passage. Nobody has a credible argument for keeping the old number.

Paid Family Leave and the childcare expansion pass together under the FAMILY Act framework — twelve weeks of paid leave and federal childcare funding both go into effect with workforce training and provider buildout running ahead of fee reductions. Like Medicare for All, this builds a constituency of every parent who uses it within the first year.

The **overtime threshold** begins stepping down from 40 hours, with small employers on a longer schedule.

Card check recognition and same-day organizing rights take effect, with the new criminal penalty structure for union-busting active immediately. The first wave of organizing under the new rules begins before the midterms.

Marijuana legalization with immediate expungement — broadly popular, builds coalition, and the expungement component tells people this administration understands that the law has costs that outlast the law.

The **financial transaction tax** and **stock buyback ban** — less immediately visible to ordinary people, but the transaction tax is the dedicated funding stream for the rail and grid buildout in Term 2, and both start changing the incentive structure of American capital from day one. **Glass-Steagall** is reinstated in the same package — commercial and investment banking are separated again, effective on a defined timeline that gives institutions time to restructure without triggering a liquidity crisis. The **step-up in basis** is eliminated for estates above $50 million and the **Buy-Borrow-Die** loan-as-realization-event rule takes effect simultaneously. Together with IRS enforcement, this is where roughly $1.5 to $1.8 trillion in projected ten-year revenue starts arriving — it has to happen now, not in Term 2, because the programs that follow depend on it.

Ranked choice voting is implemented for all federal elections in the first term. This is not incidental — it is the reform that makes every subsequent reform politically possible by breaking the two-party chokehold on electoral outcomes. It passes early because its effects compound over time and because the midterms are coming. Simultaneously, the **gerrymandering commission** is established and the first independently drawn federal district maps are produced for the next election cycle. **The Voting Rights Act** is restored in the same package. **Digital voting infrastructure** is built and tested, with full federal implementation by the end of Term 1. Turnout goes up. Higher turnout means more representative government.

Clean Elections public financing is enacted, starting with federal races: every registered voter receives a $100 voucher, individual contributions are capped at $500, and small-dollar donations are publicly matched, all administered by the independent election financing body. State and local races follow. The **Citizens United amendment** campaign launches simultaneously — it will not be ratified this term but the campaign starts the clock and gives the movement something to organize around. The **lobbying enforcement agency** is established with independent funding, subpoena power, and an elected director. The era of purchased legislation does not end overnight but the architecture for ending it is now in place.

The National Third Place Certification program launches — a low-cost, voluntary designation any qualifying business can apply for immediately. It costs the federal government almost nothing and gives the administration an early, visible example of incentive-based policy that doesn't require a fight to implement.

Codetermination passes and takes effect for all corporations above 1,000 employees. Worker-elected board seats are filled in the first election cycle. The governance shift begins changing how major corporations make decisions about offshoring, executive compensation, and capital allocation — not immediately, but the structural pressure is now present in every boardroom it reaches. **Tier 1 Monopoly designations** are filed against Amazon, Google, Meta, and Apple simultaneously, alongside Sinclair and equivalent local broadcast consolidators, the big four meatpackers, with the Packers and Stockyards Act enforced again, and the FCC ownership limits are reinstated in the same action. The two-year divestiture clock runs during litigation for all of them. Every day the monopoly litigation is in the news is a day the public is having the argument about concentrated power that this platform needs them to have.

The **MODS framework** is established and the federal data privacy architecture is operational. The digital dividend is not yet flowing — that requires the data infrastructure to mature — but the legal foundation exists. **Section 230** is reformed: immunity is preserved for genuinely passive hosting and removed for algorithmically amplified and AI-generated content. The **national service program** launches. The first cohort is in the field. The tuition exchange is live. The debt retirement track is enrolling participants.

The corporate homebuying limit and the ban on algorithmic rent-setting take effect. **Public college tuition is held to inflation,** colleges begin sharing the cost of defaulted loans, and **tuition-free community college** launches in every state that matches federal funding.

Millennial Accounts. The cost depends on the seed Congress sets. About 3.6 million children are born each year, so a $5,000 seed costs roughly $18 billion a year, paid from the earnings of the public trust built from the wealth cap, not from new taxes.

E-Verify enforcement goes active with criminal penalties for employers who don't comply. Legal immigration is streamlined and the DREAM Act is passed. **The Social Voucher** gun purchasing requirement is law. The **AI product liability statute** is enacted. **Automation notice, workplace surveillance limits, the surveillance pricing ban, and likeness protections** are enacted alongside it. **Municipal broadband bans** are preempted. **Foster care reform** is enacted: the stabilization-first removal standard takes effect, the Family Preservation Credit is funded, the certified recovery home designation is created, and the Federal Transition Bridge Fund capitalizes the move from private to public case management. The constitutional amendment campaigns **— 13th Amendment penal servitude clause repeal, Citizens United reversal, national popular vote, gerrymandering prohibition, the age cap for senators, justices, and presidents, and Supreme Court reform (single eighteen-year terms and the**

popular ratification and retention votes) — are active in state legislatures. They will not reach ratification this term. The campaigns are infrastructure for the decade, not the term.

Reproductive rights are codified federally — the standard set out in this platform's Rights and Accountability section becomes statute, not a patchwork of state law subject to reversal with the next state legislature. **Comprehensive sex education** funding and contraception coverage go into effect alongside it. **The Patriot Act authority review** begins under the twenty-five-year audit standard; whatever has not demonstrably prevented an attack sunsets on the audit's findings.

By the end of Term 1 the United States has a higher wage floor, a functioning path to universal healthcare, restored organizing rights, the beginnings of antitrust enforcement, clean federal elections, and a government that has demonstrated it can do large things competently. That last point is not incidental. The case for this platform's second term is made entirely by the first term's execution.

Term 2: The Buildout

The second term is where the structural transformation of American capital begins in earnest. The foundation is laid. The institutions exist. The constituencies are built. Now the weight-bearing reforms go in.

The **90/999 Wealth Cap** is introduced with capital flight controls active from the moment the bill is introduced — the 24-month look-back provision means the legislative debate is not a window for asset extraction. The **Exit Tax** closes the flight route. The first shares above the cap move into the public trust and the Worker Equity Fund. The wealth cap moves to Term 2 deliberately: codetermination and the minimum wage need to be established facts before the cap fight begins, because the political argument for the cap is stronger when workers are already visibly gaining power through governance and wages. The cap is the culmination of the ownership argument, not its opening move. Once the public trust is funded, every child's **Millennial Account** is seeded from its earnings.

The **National Rail and Grid Initiative** breaks ground. Construction on the first high-priority corridors — Northeast, Pacific Coast, Midwest triangle — begins generating employment immediately. The nationalized grid begins absorbing transmission and distribution lines through eminent domain purchase, phased by risk and condition. Electricity bills begin falling as the profit margin is removed. Transit and infrastructure funds flow first to communities that have legalized duplexes, triplexes, and accessory units near the new corridors, so housing supply grows where the rail goes. **Data centers** pay full cost for the grid capacity they require as the nationalized grid absorbs transmission.

The carbon border tariff goes into effect as the grid nationalization and rail buildout reach the point where electrification is economically rational at scale — the tariff corrects the pricing distortion now that the alternative infrastructure actually exists to electrify into.

The **Infrastructure Bonds** are live and the 401(k) swap program is open for enrollment.

Maglev rail construction is well underway in the primary corridors by the end of Term 2, with the first segments opening to riders and full corridor operation following within ten years of groundbreaking. The geography of the American labor market begins to shift. The **Neighborhood Renovation Initiative** is at national scale, having preceded the rail connection deliberately so that existing residents are positioned to benefit from rising property values rather than displaced by them.

The co-op choice is triggered for all firms whose market capitalization has exceeded $10 billion at any point in the prior five-year window: a worker-majority board and a 10-to-1 pay ratio, or a tax-advantaged sale to the workers. Companies that have been operating under codetermination since Term 1 face that choice with worker-elected board members already in place. The governance shift is not a surprise. It is the next stage of a process that has been underway for four years.

Tier 1 Monopoly divestitures are completed or in final execution. Amazon, Google, Meta, and Apple are structurally separated. Meatpacking divestitures are completed alongside Big Tech's. The interoperability mandate is in effect. The competitive conditions that markets require to function are being restored. The **MODS digital dividend** goes live as the data infrastructure matures. Americans begin receiving payment for the use of their data.

The amendments establishing the **age cap of 75** and **Supreme Court reform** — single eighteen-year terms, popular ratification, and retention votes — are ratified or advancing through the states. Once ratified, the age cap applies to new Senate terms, Supreme Court appointments, and presidential inaugurations, and the staggered eighteen-year schedule begins with the next vacancy. The **citizen referendum mechanism** is operational. The people have a lever that is not a petition and not a protest.

Ultra-processed food regulation is fully implemented. **Teacher compensation reform** is fully implemented — the $75,000 floor is established and the phase-in to $100,000 average is underway. The **National Popular Vote Interstate Compact** reaches 270 electoral votes. The structural conditions for a permanent electoral majority built on genuine popular support are in place.

Elder care and hospice reform take effect as Medicare for All's transition completes — private equity ownership of hospice and elder care facilities is phased out on the same timeline, and the first Hogewey-model pilot programs begin enrollment in Florida and Arizona.

The constitutional amendment campaigns continue. Some will reach ratification this decade. Others will take longer. The amendments are the long game — the legal codification of a transformation that the platform's first two terms will have already made real in practice. You do not wait for the Constitution to change the country. You change the country and the Constitution follows.

What Success Looks Like

By the end of these two terms, the United States should look like this: every American has reliable healthcare that doesn't disappear when they lose their job. The minimum wage has risen to a floor that allows everyone with a job to support themselves and participate meaningfully in the economy— that is, they can cover their basic expenses and still have enough leftover for entertainment/investment/saving for the future. Workers sit on the boards of the largest corporations in the country and aid with decision-making. The monopolies that controlled American search, social media, e-commerce, and digital infrastructure have been broken into competing pieces. Families no longer bid against investment funds for houses, ranchers sell into a competitive market again, and Social Security is funded for the next generation. The wealthiest Americans cannot accumulate political power at civilization-distorting scale. The country is building a rail network and an energy grid that will define American economic geography for the next century. The retirement savings of ordinary Americans are tied to that infrastructure rather than to the speculative positions of hedge funds. The economic might of Wall Street is properly harnessed, benefitting those who work for a living instead of the Epstein class.

None of this is guaranteed. Implementation will be imperfect. Some reforms will face legal challenges that delay or dilute them. Political coalitions are fragile and election cycles are unforgiving. The opposition will be well-funded, organized, and relentless.

But that doesn't matter. This was never going to be easy. What matters is the following — the destination is correct, the mechanisms are coherent, and continuing the current trajectory is not an option.

PART V

Where Exactly Does the Money Come From?

This question will and should be asked. Here's the answer.

Where the money comes from:

The financial transaction tax: roughly $75 billion a year. The Congressional Budget Office estimated that a 0.1% tax on stock, bond, and derivatives trades would raise $777 billion over ten years, already accounting for the drop in trading the tax would cause. High-frequency firms will pay the most at first and then trade less; the revenue rests on the whole market, not on them. All of it is dedicated to rail and grid infrastructure.

Full IRS enforcement of taxes already legally owed — not new taxes, existing ones, applied to people who are currently not paying them. Estimates from the Treasury Department and independent analysts put the recovered revenue at roughly $500 to $700 billion over ten years from enforcement alone.

Closing the step-up in basis loophole and the carried interest exemption: another $200 to $300 billion over ten years.

The wealth cap on fortunes above $999 million. This one doesn't behave like the others. America's billionaires hold about $7.8 trillion, and nearly $7 trillion of that sits above the cap. Taxed at 90%, that is a one-time structural correction of roughly $6 trillion — the largest number in this document — collected mostly in shares rather than cash, so no one is forced to dump stock on the market. Those shares go into a public trust and the Worker Equity Fund. The trust's dividends become a permanent revenue stream; what continues after that is a much smaller annual flow tied to future growth above the cap.

The carbon border tariff, estimated in the range of $12 to $25 billion annually depending on scope and design. Notably smaller than the other figures here, but it corrects a subsidy to the wrong industries rather than just raising money.

Lifting the Social Security cap. This money doesn't fund the rest of the platform; it goes straight into the Social Security trust fund, closing two-thirds of the program's long-range shortfall.

What it costs:

Medicare for All is the biggest number in this document. The Congressional Budget Office's 2020 analysis of single-payer designs found that federal health spending would rise by $1.5 trillion to $3.0 trillion a year by 2030. Most of that is not new spending. The same analysis found that total national health spending would land somewhere between $0.7 trillion lower and $0.3 trillion higher than under current law — meaning most of the federal increase replaces premiums, deductibles, and out-of-pocket costs that employers and households already pay. The reason total spending can fall is that a single public system negotiates prices the way every other wealthy country does and strips out much of the administrative overhead that private insurance billing creates — overhead that today eats a substantial share of every healthcare dollar. Those savings are already built into the CBO's range. The money moves from your paycheck deduction to the public ledger. It does not appear out of nowhere.

Universal childcare and pre-K: roughly $70 billion to $140 billion a year. The low end is Moody's Analytics' estimate for the Universal Child Care and Early Learning Act; the high end is the

National Academies of Sciences' estimate for a high-quality system with properly paid workers, which is closer to what this platform requires. Both were calculated before the last several years of inflation, so treat them as floors.

Teacher pay: roughly $75 billion a year in salary once the $100,000 average is fully phased in — about 3.2 million public school teachers, each earning on average about $23,500 more than the projected 2025-26 national average of $76,552 — and closer to $100 billion once payroll taxes and pension contributions are included. This is new money, not a reshuffling of existing federal education funds.

Tuition-free community college: roughly $9 billion a year in federal funds, based on the Department of Education's most recent proposal, about $90 billion over ten years. States that opt in cover their matching share. It is one of the cheapest items in this document and one of the most direct paths into a better-paying job.

An honest poverty line. Recalibrating federal programs to a realistic poverty measure means more families qualify for help, and that costs money. The phase-in schedule is set by statute and tied to the revenue above, and the full cost is scored by the Congressional Budget Office before passage.

The energy grid: America's investor-owned electric companies had a combined stock market value of roughly $1 trillion at the end of 2024, but their total assets were about $2.2 trillion, most of the difference being debt. Buying those companies outright, stock and debt together, would cost close to $2 trillion. This platform buys the part that is a true natural monopoly — the transmission and distribution wires — so the realistic price is well below that figure. It is financed with long-term public bonds and repaid from electricity revenue that currently goes to shareholders. It is an asset purchase, not an annual expense, but it is a large one, which is why it is phased across Term 2. And consider this: the utilities themselves plan to spend over $1.1 trillion on capital projects between 2025 and 2029, all of it recovered from ratepayers. We are already paying to build the grid. We just don't own it.

Maglev rail is the most expensive construction project in this document and the hardest to price precisely. Recent American maglev estimates have run from roughly $285 million to around $500 million per mile, driven heavily by urban tunneling; rural surface track costs less. Applied across an estimated 10,000 miles, the full network plausibly lands between $2.85 trillion and $5 trillion, spent over twenty to thirty years — roughly $95 billion to $250 billion a year.

Add it up and the recurring cost of the largest programs lands somewhere between $1.75 trillion and $3.5 trillion a year at full implementation, the vast majority of it Medicare for All — most of which, again, replaces what Americans already pay to private insurers. The revenue sources above do not cover all of that on their own. The rest comes from the healthcare dollars that shift from private to public, from the public trust's returns on the wealth cap, and from the economic growth of a country whose workers are healthier, better paid, and finally own a piece of what they build.

Managing the Transition: Inflation, the Fed, and the Bond Market

In 2022, a British prime minister announced a large package of unfunded tax cuts. Within days, the bond market panicked, interest rates spiked, pension funds nearly collapsed, and she was out of office in 49 days. The lesson is simple: markets punish governments that spend first and explain later. This platform is designed around that lesson.

Revenue comes first. The transaction tax, IRS enforcement, the step-up and Buy-Borrow-Die reforms, and the Social Security cap all take effect in Term 1. The expensive construction projects, the grid and the rail network, don't break ground until Term 2, after that revenue is flowing.

Most of the big numbers aren't new spending. Medicare for All mostly replaces premiums and out-of-pocket costs that employers and families already pay; the money changes route, not size. The grid buyout swaps government bonds for utility assets and is repaid from electricity bills customers already pay. Neither pours new money into the economy all at once.

Big changes phase in. The minimum wage rises over five years. Medicare for All transitions over four. Maglev is a thirty-year project. Gradual increases give businesses time to adjust and keep price spikes from feeding on each other.

An automatic brake. If core inflation stays above 4% for two consecutive quarters, the pace of construction spending on rail and infrastructure automatically slows until it comes back down. Healthcare, wages, and Social Security are never on the chopping block; the brake applies to the projects that can wait.

The Federal Reserve stays independent. This platform does not tell the Fed what to do, pressure it on interest rates, or depend on cheap money to work. A central bank that politicians can lean on is another form of concentrated power, and the bond market knows it.

Building capacity fights inflation. Inflation happens when money chases too few goods and workers. Much of this platform adds supply: tens of thousands of new childcare workers, a national service corps trained in the trades, rail that lowers transportation costs, a grid that lowers energy costs, and competitive markets where monopolies used to set prices. Over time, a country that builds things gets cheaper to live in.

Show the math in public. Before each term's major legislation passes, the full ten-year cost and revenue estimates are scored by the Congressional Budget Office and published in plain language. Nothing big moves without the numbers attached. Markets don't fear ambitious governments. They fear governments that hide the bill.

What we're already paying:

But more than that, the fact of the matter is this: we're already paying for a multitrillion-dollar system and getting nothing substantial for it. The majority of the current system's participants are getting bare sustenance, if that. We pay for the current system in medical debt, one of the most common drivers of personal bankruptcy in the United States. We pay for it in wages that have grown at a fraction of the pace of productivity for fifty years. We pay for it in infrastructure that fails during storms and lets people freeze to death. We pay for it with a prison system that costs over $40,000 per person per year while most people released are rearrested within a few years. We pay for it in a roughly $890 billion annual military budget that has failed eight consecutive audits and cannot account for trillions in assets and expenditures. We pay for it every April when we spend $150 and four hours on taxes because a software company lobbied to keep the free version from existing.

And what are we getting for this? The personal fortunes of a few thousand people ballooning to levels never before seen in history. The other 342 million of us deserve our life, liberty, and pursuit of happiness, too.

A Thousand Years

The Romans did not build the aqueducts because they expected to be remembered. They built them because they had to, because cities were dying of thirst and they had to figure out how to move water. The aqueducts outlasted the empire by centuries. Some are still in use.

This platform is not offered as a complete solution. It is offered as a serious attempt — built on what we now know about incentive structures, institutional design, and the specific mechanisms of capture — to build something that holds longer than what came before it.

One person, one vote. One worker, one share. One law that applies to everyone.

Establish justice. Insure domestic tranquility. Provide for the common defense. Promote the general welfare. Life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness.

Do we hold these truths to be self-evident or not?

The full platform document—with complete policy detail, historical grounding, implementation sequencing, and legal architecture—is available separately.

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